

Addis Ababa University
College of Education and Behavioral Studies
Department of Special Needs Education

Inclusiveness

Chapter 4

Promoting Inclusive Culture

Brainstorming question

1. What is culture ?
2. What does an inclusive culture mean?
3. What is the role of culture to create an inclusive community?
4. What are cultures that should be encouraged and cultures that should be discourage ?
5. In your culture, how person with disability is seen and treated ?

4.1. Definition of Inclusive Culture

- Culture is “the ideas, customs, and social behavior of a particular people or society.”
- Culture is our way of living, it refers to the shared language, beliefs, values, norms, behaviors, and material objects that are passed down from one generation to the next.
- Culture plays a huge role in accommodating the diverse needs of individuals and groups.
- An inclusive culture involves the **full** and **successful integration** of diverse people in different forms of areas where people will **work** and **live** together such as **work place**, **schools**, **villages** etc.

- Inclusive culture encompasses both formal and informal policies and practices, and involves several **core values** such as:
 - **Representation:** (The presence of people with disabilities across a range of membership and leadership within the community and given institution);
 - **Receptivity:** (Respect for differences);
 - **Fairness:** (Equitable **access** to all **resources**, **opportunities**, **networks** and **decision-making** processes).

4.2. Dimensions of inclusive culture

- There are **three dimensions/elements** of an inclusive culture:

1. Universal design refers to the construction of structures, spaces, services, communications and resources that are organically accessible to a range of people with and without disabilities, without further need for modification or accommodation.

2. Recruitment (Training and Advancement Opportunities). This dimension of inclusive culture refers to the promotion of recruitment and training of PWDs for a certain position and advance their professional knowledge and competence.

3. Workplace Accommodations and Accessibility (Policy & Practice) plays a critical role in generating meaningful inclusion of people with disabilities.

- In addition to recruitment, training and advancement, workplace policies need to be carefully planned for the provision of reasonable accommodations.

Brainstorming question ?

- 1. What are the characteristics of inclusive culture?**
- 2. How can we build an inclusive culture ?**
- 3. Who is responsible in creating an inclusive culture**
- 4. What will be the benefit of inclusive culture for people with disability**

4.3. Building inclusive community

- An inclusive community:
 - Establishes foundation that **respects** all citizens, gives them full access to resources, and promotes equal treatment and opportunity;
 - Works to eliminate all forms of **discrimination**;
 - Engages all its citizens in **decision-making** processes that affect their lives;
 - **Values diversity**; and
 - Responds quickly to racist and other discriminating incidents.

- An inclusive society aims at:
 - ❖ empowering and promoting social, economic, and political inclusion of all, irrespective of age, sex, disability, race, ethnicity, origin, religion, economic, or other status.
 - ❖ It is a society that leaves no one behind.
 - ❖ societies are open and inclusive to all.
- Inclusive community is important for the following reasons;
 - Acts of exclusion and injustice
 - All people have the right to be part of decisions and
 - Diversity enriches our lives, so value our community's diversity.

- An inclusive community is characterized by the following features:
 - Integrative and cooperative;
 - Interactive;
 - Invested; both the public and private sectors commit resources for the social and economic health and well-being of the whole community.
 - Diverse;
 - Equitable;
 - Accessible and Sensitive;
 - Participatory;
 - Safe.

- In an inclusive society or institution having inclusive culture, there is a need of **leaders having inclusive behavior** such as:
 - **Empowerment**; Enable team members to grow and excel by encouraging them to solve problems, come up with new ideas and develop new skills.
 - **Accountability**; Show confidence in team members by holding them responsible for aspects of their performance that are within their control.

–**Courage;**

Stand up for what you believe is right, even when it means taking a risk.

–**Humility/ Humbleness/**

Admit mistakes, learn from criticism and different points of view, and overcome your limitations by seeking contributions from team members.

4.5. Inclusive values in terms of cultural norms

- Inclusion is most importantly seen as putting inclusive values into action.
- The seven pillars of inclusion are:
 - Access;
 - Attitude;
 - Choice;
 - Partnership;
 - Communication;
 - Policy; and
 - Opportunity.

- Alongside these pillars of inclusion, the following are the frameworks of inclusive values:
 - Equality;
 - Rights;
 - Participation;
 - Community;
 - Respect for Diversity;
 - Sustainability;
 - Non-violence;

- Trust;
- Compassion;
- Honesty;
- Courage;
- Joy;
- Love;
- Hope/Optimism; and
- Beauty.

A framework of
inclusive values



4.6. Indigenous Inclusive Values and Practices

- *Indigenous values* are customs and norms of a society developed in the course of the past cultural practices and enriched and transferred from generation to generation.
- Incorporating Indigenous ways of learning into educational practices has potential to benefit both Indigenous and non-Indigenous learners.

- In **modern curriculum** the following skills are needed to be included:
 - Collaboration;
 - Creativity;
 - Innovation;
 - Problem-solving;
 - Inquiry;
 - Multicultural literacy, etc.
- Indigenous knowledge and practice should be carefully treated avoiding harmful cultural beliefs.

Activities

1. What are the manifestations of inclusive culture?
2. What are the key values of inclusive culture?
3. What are the benefits of inclusive culture to PWDs?